

knew how to rehab them. And I think that the shining example of that is Pat Cummins. As a young kid, he got stress fractures in the back and missed five years of cricket. You know, he was trying to come back, but he was still injured, and Cricket Australia took him aside. They gave him a programme.

Who is your favourite Indian pace bowler?

I must say my favourite is Mohammed Shami. I know he's injured now, but I saw him when I was coaching the West Indies in India in a Test match. And my word, the skill level of that bowler is unbelievable. He's fast. He's not tall. He's very strong and accurate. He's very skinny, but I just love his seam presentation. He's always at you. He looks like he's injured running in. It looks like he's hobbling on one leg, but then he comes in and bowls at 145 kmph. Jasprit Bumrah is a real-class bowler with very difficult actions to correct your rhythm and timing as a batsman.

And then you have Mohammed Siraj... He's in your face. He's the one who stirs the pot, but he's also got some good skill and pace. India has produced some world-class fast bowlers for many years now, the last five to 10 years, and I think it was something that was missing in their repertoire. They always had spin. They had skilled bowlers who could bowl swing and a little bit of seam, but now they have some of the fastest bowlers on the planet. Mayank Yadav is quick. I was watching him in the IPL.

Shami had an Achilles injury and surgery, so he will be out for an extended period. But regarding his comeback after an Achilles injury as a coach, do you think he will be the same Shami that we saw pre-Achilles surgery?

It'll depend on which leg it is. I'm unaware of which leg it is, whether it's his left leg that he lands on or, you know, if it's not his landing leg, he's got more of a chance, but he probably won't be the same. One thing that won't leave his body is his



« **World Cups are very special to play, and they don't come around very often. Fingers crossed, we can get out there and give a good account of ourselves.**

skill level. I hope he comes back. If he doesn't, I think that'll be understandable considering the injury he's had, but, fingers crossed, he gets fit and is back, terrorising the batsman.

Regarding the Australia team for the World Cup, were you surprised by any exclusions or inclusions?

To be honest, not really. Probably the biggest talking point will be Steve Smith. Everyone else will say Jake Fraser-McGurk, but the big talking point will be Smith missing out. I think for a long time, he's been a wonderful player, but he's probably not where Twenty20 cricket is now. You know, the way that those teams are set up now, they don't have a player who bats at number 3. If they lose two quick wickets, they go in to stop the wicket flow.

They just send someone in to try and hit six and some, so that's how the game's gone. So maybe it doesn't suit certain players, necessarily. Smith, I think, as I said before, is a wonderful player, but there may be better options in Australian cricket. The rest of the team is the team that won the 2021 World Cup in Abu Dhabi. It's pretty much how it should be.

Have you been following the IPL closely?

Not closely, but close enough. It's a bit difficult to get coverage in the hotels here in the US on the IPL. The wickets have grass on them; there is good, even bounce as well, and the boundaries are 65 metres. So, there is not much chance for the bowlers in those conditions, but some of the batting has been unbelievable. Sunrisers Hyderabad have been great in that respect, with Travis

Head opening and playing brilliantly and Heinrich Klassen coming in and finishing it off. It has just been good to watch.

Who do you like better? Stuart Law, the cricketer, or Stuart Law, the coach?

If you ask someone else, they probably don't like either. All day long, I'd rather be a player. But having said that, I'm pretty comfortable with what I did and where I am right now. I'm just happy being who I am and enjoying my time. You know, it's been a long ride in the game of cricket. The game of cricket has been great for me. So I've only got a few more years left to be the coach, but we might be playing every day of the week.

What kind of legacy does Stuart Law want to leave behind?

As a player, I always wanted to be a tough competitor. I think I achieved that in my career. As a coach, an understanding coach, it took me a while. It's been a long ride, but getting the terms took me a while. So, I was still in my early years as a coach and probably more swayed by the playing mentality than the coaching mentality. I want to leave with the memories of the people I coached who said I was hard but fair. I was always, you know, approachable, and hopefully, I'll produce some good cricketers for years to come.

I look back fondly on the boys I've coached in under-19 Bangladesh. We had Najmul Shanto, who's now captain of Bangladesh. I had a bit to do with him during an under-19 World Cup, and seeing them perform well on the world stage gives me a really good feeling inside. I'd like to continue doing that.